Gramsci), and how it relates to the state, is very different in each country.

There are many difficulties for Brazilian movements and NGOs to find common ground for dialogue with Chinese and Russian organisations, for example. The latter tend to be very close to their governments, and they differ on issues such as the green economy, extraction or social participation. A dialogue with the South Africans is in some ways easier, and, in some cases, it had already been set in place by international campaigns and protests for decades prior to the BRICS.

Interestingly, the theme 'BRICS' is being explored in a more systematic way by agencies and NGOs 'from the North' rather than 'from the South'. For the latter, the group is still somewhat abstract; it is not realised in the struggles and social processes in the territories. What we see, rather, are South African, Brazilian, Chinese, Indian and Russian multinationals, mainly in the extractive sector, which have been generating negative impacts in the territories and, in such cases, generating processes of resistance.

Despite the differences, we can identify some similar experiences of impact, confrontation and resistance, plus themes that are common to the peoples of the BRICS. There are, for example, experiences with mega-events and related violations of rights (the World Cup and Olympics in Brazil, China, South Africa and Russia, and the Commonwealth Games in India). In the five countries, there are many instances of socio-environmental conflicts involving mega-projects of oil, gas and mining, and also rights violations around mega-infrastructure projects involving funding by national development banks. These will all very likely be amplified by the future NDB. In other words, international solidarity and the articulation and strengthening of societies in the BRICS will occur in processes of struggle, insofar as these countries move forward in the development model that they follow today.

One difficulty for the cohesion and articulation of these social movements today is the fact that they have different views on the meaning of the BRICS in the world order. Some movements and organisations are closer to the positions of governments. They tend to characterise the BRICS more optimistically, as a possible alternative pole, balancing with Western powers, leading to a democratisation of the world order. Other movements and organisations are critical of their governments from various points of view, especially of development strategies with high socio-environmental risk and little or no channel for effective social participation. Their view is that the BRICS are 'more of the same', that is, a strengthening of global capitalism and the predatory accumulation of capital, not generating a real alternative to US and global power.